



### Google Sodar

Google's new Sodar tool is aimed at helping Android smartphone users maintain social distancing. <https://dgit.in/jun20-15>



### MS Flight sim updates

Microsoft's spectacular looking Flight Simulator is updated as often as once per 28 days. <https://dgit.in/jun20-16>

details. There are over 500 sculptures surrounding the steps, some large and some small. These depict mythological and secular imagery (secular here means scenes of everyday life of the common folk), and there are a few abstract geometric lattices thrown in as well. The design of the stepwell is truly unique, and is constructed like an inverted temple. The entire site has been preserved in 3D by the Cyark initiative, and you can actually visit this location from the comfort of your homes.

### GUCHHUPANI

Better known as Robber's cave, this is located about an hour's drive from Dehradun. It is a popular picnic spot for the locals, and there is a river running beside the cave. Legend has it that in the times past, robbers had a hideout in the caves. And yes, there are no accounts of hidden loot. This is a fun place to visit because the entire walk takes place through narrow caverns, through knee deep water. There is a water fall within the cave. One of the interesting features is the source of the water, there is a patch of running water that appears on the cave floor, then disappears back into the cave floor, with the water gushing out again after some distance.

### LIVING ROOT BRIDGES

If you are making the trip to the Arwah caves, it make sense to visit the nearby village of Mawlynnong as well. The village has become a popular tourist destination based on its reputation of being the cleanest village in Asia and India. The location is really one of pristine beauty, with no plastics or smoking allowed. The mostly natural waste is collected in bamboo dustbins and used for manure. But the most important reason to visit are the living root bridges, built over generations. These are bridges made out of the roots of living trees, and keep growing over the years.

### SPACE MUSEUM

The Space Museum is located at the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launching Station (TERLS), which is an active

launch site for sounding rockets, which you can witness every third wednesday, so plan your visit accordingly. This is the site where the Indian space program was born, and the St Mary Magdalene Church which was used to assemble the rockets has been converted into the museum with an assortment of the latest devices and gizmos. You can see the heat shield of a PSLV, a full scale PSLV, and scaled down models of the remaining rockets in ISRO's fleet. There is also a theatre with a show on the space program.

### SUNDER NURSERY

This is a beautiful garden hidden in plain sight in New Delhi, and is the



Sunder nursery

oldest arboreum in India. Continuously maintained by the Mughals, the Britishers and the Indian government, this garden has only grown over the years. You can find some really rare trees here, some of which are the only ones growing in Delhi. There is also a rose garden with a variety of different roses. The park is also home to many rare bird and butterfly species. This is a location steeped in history, the Grand Trunk Road is adjacent to the nursery, and peppered around the gardens are no less than six UNESCO world heritage sites.

### VASOTA FORT

This one is a little difficult to visit

because you need to get permission to even get to the place. The access to the fort is through a boat ride, and if you are starting from Mumbai it might take an entire day just to reach the place. There is a campsite by the forest department, where you can spend a lazy evening by the Shivsagar lake, and watch the stars in the clear skies above, far away from any light pollution. The trail goes up to Babukada, which is the second highest cliff in Maharashtra, one that is not as well known as Kokankada, but just as spectacular. The environment is pristine, you can literally just walk up to nesting birds and they will not even flinch. There are gigantic bats in the periphery

of the jungle, which has all kinds of beasts in it. This is a great trek through a core jungle area.

### YUMTHANG VALLEY

There are many places that bear the name "valley of flowers" in India, but this one in Sikkim really lives up to the name. The flowers start blooming in February, and are visible till the end of June. They carpet the valley floor in all the hues of the rainbow. The only place to stay for the night is a forest rest house. The valley also houses the Shingba Rhododendron Sanctuary which has over twenty four species of rhododendron. Also, you get to see Yaks grazing in the countryside! 